CANVA PPT LINK: GROUP 6 CASE STUDY PPT
Note: The group is free to assume what industry Innealtoir, Inc. belongs to.

Innealtoir Inc, <REPLACE WITH WHICH INDUSTRY TO BELONG>

TASKS:

- ☑ ~~1 - Choose the final 5 ERPs~~
- ☑ ~~2 - Create/adopt an ERP Evaluation Checklist~~
- ☐ 3 - Conduct an ERP Readiness Assessment focusing on **Question 8: Components to implement and prioritization**.
- ☐ 4 - Summarize findings using the **ERP Evaluation Template**
- ☐ 5- Write a Final Recommendation
  - ☐ The ERP system recommended for Innealtoir, Inc.
  - ☐ Key reasons for choosing it over others.
  - ☐ Which modules to implement first and why.

Step 1 - ERP List:

- ☑ ~~**SAP S/4HANA** - for an enterprise-grade solution~~
- ☑ ~~**Oracle NetSuite** - for the best all-around ERP software~~
- ☑ ~~**Microsoft Dynamics 365** - for dynamic use cases~~
- ☑ ~~**Odoo** - for custom business processes~~
- ☑ ~~**Acumatica** - for best user experience~~
- ☐ **Epicor** - for manufacturing and distribution industries
- ☐ **Infor** - for streamlining manufacturing operations
- ☐ **Sage Intacct** - for finance and accounting
- ☐ **ERPNext** - for best value ERP

Step 2 - ERP Evaluation Checklist : 4.1.3 ERP Evaluation Checklist: [1251_ITISSES_S15] - SPECIAL ENTERPRISE SYSTEMS

SAP S/4HANA

	Evaluation Category	Key Questions & Considerations
☑	System Functionality	Does it offer core modules (financial management, inventory control, supply chain, HR, CRM) needed to address your business challenges and requirements? Yes; S/4HANA covers finance, inventory, procurement, production/MRP, supply chain, HR (via SAP SuccessFactors),

		and CRM (via SAP Sales/Service) with deep manufacturing/distribution capabilities.
☑	Customization & Configuration	Can the system be tailored to your unique business processes without extensive coding or software modifications? Business processes can be tailored primarily through configuration and SAP Best Practices, with extensibility via SAP BTP (low-code, APIs, ABAP RESTful) that avoids heavy core code changes.
☑	Deployment Options	Does the vendor offer cloud-based or on-premises deployment aligned with your IT strategy? If cloud-based, can users access data via a web browser without installing additional software? Available as **S/4HANA Cloud** (public/private editions) and **on-premise**, all accessible via a web browser using SAP Fiori UX.
☑	Integration Capabilities	Can the ERP integrate with your existing systems (e.g., CRM, e-commerce platforms, third-party apps)? Does it support seamless data exchange with other business applications and hardware? Robust integrations through SAP BTP, prebuilt connectors, and open APIs enable seamless data flow with SAP and non-SAP apps, e-commerce platforms, and external hardware.
☑	Scalability and Flexibility	Can it support business growth—handling more transactions, users, and modules over time? Will it adapt smoothly as your needs evolve? The in-memory HANA platform scales for high transaction volumes, users, and additional modules while supporting process evolution over time.
☑	User Experience	Is the interface intuitive, user-friendly, and consistent across all modules? Will it encourage quick adoption across your organization? SAP Fiori provides a modern, role-based, consistent UI across modules that improves usability and supports faster adoption.

☑	Reporting and Analytics	Does it provide real-time insights with built-in tools? Can you create customizable reports and interactive dashboards? Embedded analytics, real-time operational reporting via CDS views, and native integration with SAP Analytics Cloud allow customizable dashboards and reports.
☑	Mobile Compatibility	Can users access critical data and processes from mobile devices? Is the interface responsive across screen sizes, resolutions, and orientations? Does it support touch functionality? Fiori apps are responsive and mobile-ready, with native mobile options for common workflows and touch-optimized interactions.
☐	Pricing Structure	Is the total cost of ownership transparent—including licensing/subscription fees, implementation, maintenance, upgrades, and support? Pricing is enterprise-grade and can be complex (subscriptions/licenses plus implementation, hosting, and support), so TCO clarity requires a scoped quote and partner estimate.
☑	Support and Training	What training and technical support is offered during and after implementation? Are there tiered support packages? Does the vendor provide industry-specific expertise? Extensive global partner ecosystem, SAP support tiers, and SAP Learning Hub/Help Portal provide strong implementation and post-go-live enablement.
☑	Vendor Reputation	How reliable and established is the vendor? Can they provide customer references and success stories? Do existing customers report positive experiences with implementation, support quality, and ROI? SAP is a long-established ERP leader with broad industry references and proven ROI in large and mid-market manufacturing and distribution.
☑	Data Security and Privacy	What security measures are in place? Are there role-based access controls, data encryption, strong user authentication, and compliance with data privacy regulations (e.g., GDPR, CCPA)?

		Enterprise security features include role-based access, SSO/MFA, encryption, audit trails, and certifications that support compliance with regulations like GDPR and CCPA.

Oracle NetSuite

	Evaluation Category	**Key Questions & Considerations**
☑	System Functionality	Does it offer core modules (financial management, inventory control, supply chain, HR, CRM) needed to address your business challenges and requirements? - Offers all core modules listed above, and can be used for the whole manufacturing process.
☑	Customization & Configuration	Can the system be tailored to your unique business processes without extensive coding or software modifications? - Has **SuiteCloud and SuiteScript for customizations**. (BUT, may require additional costs depending on the usage limit and type of customization)
☑	Deployment Options	Does the vendor offer cloud-based or on-premises deployment aligned with your IT strategy? If cloud-based, can users access data via a web browser without installing additional software? - Cloud-based and can access the system through a web browser
☑	Integration Capabilities	Can the ERP integrate with your existing systems (e.g., CRM, e-commerce platforms, third-party apps)? Does it support seamless data exchange with other business applications and hardware? - Can integrate with existing systems. Has an **API called SuiteTalk that enables NetSuite to integrate with external systems seamlessly.**
☑	Scalability and Flexibility	Can it support business growth—handling more transactions, users, and modules over time? Will it adapt smoothly as your needs evolve? - **Highly scalable and can increase transaction, users, and module volumes when required because of the cloud architecture.**
☑	User Experience	Is the interface intuitive, user-friendly, and consistent across all modules? Will it encourage quick adoption across your organization? - Interface is user-friendly and consistent across the whole system, requiring minimal training.

☑	Reporting and Analytics	Does it provide real-time insights with built-in tools? Can you create customizable reports and interactive dashboards? - Offers real-time reporting and analytics tools. **SuiteAnalytics can be used to create customizable reports and dashboards** (ex. inventory levels, order status)
☑	Mobile Compatibility	Can users access critical data and processes from mobile devices? Is the interface responsive across screen sizes, resolutions, and orientations? Does it support touch functionality? - Has mobile compatibility. Users can download the **NetSuite mobile app to access the system**
☑	Pricing Structure	Is the total cost of ownership transparent—including licensing/subscription fees, implementation, maintenance, upgrades, and support? - BUT, manufacturers should consult for an accurate quote with NetSuite since subscriptions are tailored to the specific needs of the company.
☑	Support and Training	What training and technical support is offered during and after implementation? Are there tiered support packages? Does the vendor provide industry-specific expertise? - NetSuite offers multiple support and training options. **SuiteAnswers is a repository of how-to guides, documents, and videos. NetSuite Virtual Support Assistant is an AI-powered chatbot that offers answers, and the NetSuite Support Community enables users to ask questions to get expert advice** from other NetSuite users and professionals
☑	Vendor Reputation	How reliable and established is the vendor? Can they provide customer references and success stories? Do existing customers report positive experiences with implementation, support quality, and ROI? - Established reputation, with many customer references and success stories posted on Oracle
☑	Data Security and Privacy	What security measures are in place? Are there role-based access controls, data encryption, strong user authentication, and compliance with data privacy regulations (e.g., GDPR, CCPA)? - Offers RBAC, data encryption, and 2FA user authentication. Compliance GDPR, CCPA, SOC 1, 2, 3 Reports. With Data Backup and Disaster Recovery

Microsoft Dynamics 365

	Evaluation Category	**Key Questions & Considerations**

☑	System Functionality	Does it offer core modules (financial management, inventory control, supply chain, HR, CRM) needed to address your business challenges and requirements? Dynamics 365 includes robust ERP modules such as Finance, Supply Chain Management, Commerce, Human Resources, and Project Operations. It also integrates with CRM modules for sales and customer service. This covers all essential ERP areas.
☑	Customization & Configuration	Can the system be tailored to your unique business processes without extensive coding or software modifications? [PARTIALLY MET] Offers strong configuration and low-code customization via Microsoft Power Apps and Power Automate. However, deeper customizations often require developer involvement and can increase complexity.
☑	Deployment Options	Does the vendor offer cloud-based or on-premises deployment aligned with your IT strategy? If cloud-based, can users access data via a web browser without installing additional software? Available primarily as a cloud-based SaaS (Software-as-a-Service) solution on Microsoft Azure. It also supports hybrid and limited on-premises deployments for larger enterprises. Web-based access requires no installation.
☑	Integration Capabilities	Can the ERP integrate with your existing systems (e.g., CRM, e-commerce platforms, third-party apps)? Does it support seamless data exchange with other business applications and hardware? Integrates seamlessly with Microsoft 365 (Office), Power BI, and Azure services. It also supports APIs and connectors for third-party platforms like Shopify or Salesforce, ensuring smooth data exchange.
☑	Scalability and Flexibility	Can it support business growth—handling more transactions, users, and modules over time? Will it adapt smoothly as your needs evolve? Cloud-native design allows scaling users, transactions, and modules as a business grows. Modular licensing lets organizations adopt only what they need and expand later.

☑	User Experience	Is the interface intuitive, user-friendly, and consistent across all modules? Will it encourage quick adoption across your organization? [PARTIALLY MET] Uses Microsoft's modern, consistent interface with built-in accessibility. However, due to the suite's breadth, new users may face a learning curve until processes are adapted.
☑	Reporting and Analytics	Does it provide real-time insights with built-in tools? Can you create customizable reports and interactive dashboards? Comes with built-in analytics and reporting powered by Power BI. Users can create real-time dashboards, KPI visualizations, and interactive reports with customizable data views.
☑	Mobile Compatibility	Can users access critical data and processes from mobile devices? Is the interface responsive across screen sizes, resolutions, and orientations? Does it support touch functionality? The *Dynamics 365 for Phones* app from the Google Play Store and Apple App Store allows users to access data and approve workflows on smartphones or tablets. The mobile app is fully mobile-enabled and has a responsive design.
☑	Pricing Structure	Is the total cost of ownership transparent—including licensing/subscription fees, implementation, maintenance, upgrades, and support? [PARTIALLY MET] Transparent subscription-based pricing by user and module. However, the total cost of ownership varies depending on implementation, partner fees, and support. Costs can rise with complex configurations.
☑	Support and Training	What training and technical support is offered during and after implementation? Are there tiered support packages? Does the vendor provide industry-specific expertise? [PARTIALLY MET] Microsoft provides official documentation, certification programs, and partner-led support. Training quality depends on the chosen implementation partner and user engagement.

☑	Vendor Reputation	How reliable and established is the vendor? Can they provide customer references and success stories? Do existing customers report positive experiences with implementation, support quality, and ROI? Microsoft is a globally established technology leader with decades of ERP/CRM experience. Dynamics 365 is widely adopted across industries, reflecting strong vendor credibility and reliability.
☑	Data Security and Privacy	What security measures are in place? Are there role-based access controls, data encryption, strong user authentication, and compliance with data privacy regulations (e.g., GDPR, CCPA)? Dynamics 365 employs robust security measures through Microsoft Azure infrastructure. It features role-based access control, multi-factor authentication (via Azure Active Directory), encryption of data at rest and in transit (TLS, TDE), and auditing/logging of system activities. Microsoft complies with key data privacy regulations such as GDPR, ISO 27001, SOC, and CCPA, and offers data residency options to meet regional compliance needs. Overall, its security framework is strong, though effectiveness depends on proper configuration, access management, and adherence to governance best practices.

Odoo

	Evaluation Category	**Key Questions & Considerations**
☑	System Functionality	Does it offer core modules (financial management, inventory control, supply chain, HR, CRM) needed to address your business challenges and requirements? Odoo offers a comprehensive suite of core modules: financial management, inventory control, supply chain management, human resource, and customer relationship management that covers almost entirely of usual business operations.
☑	Customization & Configuration	Can the system be tailored to your unique business processes without extensive coding or software modifications?

		Odoo is highly customizable. It provides flexibility and configurability that allows a business to effectively design their workflow based on their specific processes. It features a drag and drop interface, eliminating the need for coding and software modifications.
☑	Deployment Options	Does the vendor offer cloud-based or on-premises deployment aligned with your IT strategy? If cloud-based, can users access data via a web browser without installing additional software? Yes, Odoo provides its users the ability to choose between cloud-based or on-premises deployment. They can access the data through the web server without other additional software. However, this is only available through the Odoo Enterprise version.
☑	Integration Capabilities	Can the ERP integrate with your existing systems (e.g., CRM, e-commerce platforms, third-party apps)? Does it support seamless data exchange with other business applications and hardware? Odoo allows ERP integration with existing systems and third party apps. such as Shopify, Amazon, and Paypal. Enables real-time data exchange across CRM, e-commerce platforms and applications.
☑	Scalability and Flexibility	Can it support business growth—handling more transactions, users, and modules over time? Will it adapt smoothly as your needs evolve? Odoo is built to support business growth and scalability through its modular architecture, allowing businesses to start with essential modules, and add more as they expand. However, scalability may depend on the system's technical setup and may require technical expertise from developers to maintain performance.
☑	User Experience	Is the interface intuitive, user-friendly, and consistent across all modules? Will it encourage quick adoption across your organization? Odoo provides a smooth user experience with intuitive and consistent design that ensures smooth user seamless adoption.

☑	Reporting and Analytics	Does it provide real-time insights with built-in tools? Can you create customizable reports and interactive dashboards? Yes, Odoo provides real-time insights, customizable reports, and interactive dashboards that allows the company to monitor performance and operations.
☑	Mobile Compatibility	Can users access critical data and processes from mobile devices? Is the interface responsive across screen sizes, resolutions, and orientations? Does it support touch functionality? Yes, Odoo has a mobile application that allows the company to access critical business data and processes. It supports various screen sizes, operating systems and touch gestures.
☑	Pricing Structure	Is the total cost of ownership transparent—including licensing/subscription fees, implementation, maintenance, upgrades, and support? Yes, Odoo provides two versions, community and enterprise. Community is free, while Enterprise is subscription-based pricing plans. These pricing structures are provided on the website. However, pricing may change depending on customizations, implementations, and support needs.
☑	Support and Training	What training and technical support is offered during and after implementation? Are there tiered support packages? Does the vendor provide industry-specific expertise? There is tutorials, documentation, and technical support offered in Odoo to guide implementations. There are also partner-led industry-specific expertise such as CandiRoot for Manufacturing ERP development.
☑	Vendor Reputation	How reliable and established is the vendor? Can they provide customer references and success stories? Do existing customers report positive experiences with implementation, support quality, and ROI? Yes, Odoo is a reliable, globally recognized ERP vendor that has a strong track record of customer satisfaction and successful implementations. They also provide case studies to illustrate success stories and implementations

☑	Data Security and Privacy	What security measures are in place? Are there role-based access controls, data encryption, strong user authentication, and compliance with data privacy regulations (e.g., GDPR, CCPA)? Odoo provides ACLs, data transmission is encrypted with SSL/TLS, complies with GDPR, and secure hosting environment, and maintains audit trails.

Acumatica

	Evaluation Category	**Key Questions & Considerations**
☑	System Functionality	Does it offer core modules (financial management, inventory control, supply chain, HR, CRM) needed to address your business challenges and requirements? - Covers key manufacturing and distribution needs, including inventory, production, order processing, supply chain, CRM and finance, ensuring full visibility and control across operations.
☑	Customization & Configuration	Can the system be tailored to your unique business processes without extensive coding or software modifications? - Its low-code, modular setup allows quick customization of workflows and reports to fit production cycles and warehouse processes without heavy coding.
☑	Deployment Options	Does the vendor offer cloud-based or on-premises deployment aligned with your IT strategy? If cloud-based, can users access data via a web browser without installing additional software? - Available in cloud, on-premise, or hybrid models, offers browser-based access for real-time coordination across plants and warehouses.
☑	Integration Capabilities	Can the ERP integrate with your existing systems (e.g., CRM, e-commerce platforms, third-party apps)? Does it support seamless data exchange with other business applications and hardware? - Integrates seamlessly with tools like Power BI, Microsoft 365, barcode scanners and shipping systems through open APIs for smooth data flow.
☑	Scalability and Flexibility	Can it support business growth—handling more transactions, users, and modules over time? Will it adapt smoothly as your needs evolve? - Scales easily as operations grow, and its

		resource-based pricing model is ideal for large teams and fluctuating workloads.
☑	User Experience	Is the interface intuitive, user-friendly, and consistent across all modules? Will it encourage quick adoption across your organization? - Has a clean, intuitive interface with role-based dashboards that helps users navigate easily and focus on relevant manufacturing or sales data.
☑	Reporting and Analytics	Does it provide real-time insights with built-in tools? Can you create customizable reports and interactive dashboards? - Provides real-time dashboard and Power BI integration for tracking KPIs such as lead time, order accuracy and production costs.
☑	Mobile Compatibility	Can users access critical data and processes from mobile devices? Is the interface responsive across screen sizes, resolutions, and orientations? Does it support touch functionality? - Fully mobile-ready, allowing field and warehouse teams to access real-time data and update orders from any device.
☑	Pricing Structure	Is the total cost of ownership transparent—including licensing/subscription fees, implementation, maintenance, upgrades, and support? - Pricing is based on system usage, not user count, and is also cost efficient for operations with many users and varying activity levels.
☑	Support and Training	What training and technical support is offered during and after implementation? Are there tiered support packages? Does the vendor provide industry-specific expertise? - Offers strong partner support and free training through Acumatic Open University, with resources tailored to manufacturing workflows.
☑	Vendor Reputation	How reliable and established is the vendor? Can they provide customer references and success stories? Do existing customers report positive experiences with implementation, support quality, and ROI? - Highly rated by Gartner and G2, has a solid reputation for flexibility and innovation in manufacturing and distribution ERP.
☑	Data Security and Privacy	What security measures are in place? Are there role-based access controls, data encryption, strong user authentication, and compliance with data privacy regulations (e.g., GDPR, CCPA)? - Implements robust security with role-based access,

		encryption and compliance with SOC(Security Operations Center) and GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation) standards.

Step 3 - ERP Readiness Assessment

1. **Current issues prompting ERP implementation**

Innealtoir Inc. is a medium-sized manufacturing company that is encountering issues in their production process. They experience product process inefficiency due to manual and paper-based processes that has led to various operational challenges. There is no system to see real-time inventory, production scheduling, or supply chain status, making coordination difficult. Moreover, different departments use their own separate systems, leading to inconsistencies, while finance, production, inventory management, and even procurement are processed separately. This fragmentation results in a lack of data reporting and analytics that can help with strategizing and decision-making. Overall, these problems raise the need to integrate an efficient ERP system.

2. **Documented ERP strategy**

The ERP strategy focuses on improving the production process by eliminating manual and paper-based documentation and unifying the processes of different departments to enhance reporting and workflow through real-time visibility of all components.

3. **Assessing current business processes**

Key processes in manufacturing were identified to reveal inefficiencies and opportunities. Procurement, inventory management, production planning, and sales distribution were reviewed, revealing that each department's respective systems relied on manual processes and were largely disconnected from one another. This fragmentation required an additional workflow whose main purpose is to unify their data and enable analytics. These pain points will be addressed through the proposed ERP system.

4. **Documenting shared organizational values**

For Innealtoir Inc., documenting shared organizational values is essential for shaping a successful ERP implementation. The company values collaboration, efficiency, innovation, and data-driven decision-making. Collaboration is a key focus, ensuring that all departments work together to unify processes and eliminate silos. Efficiency is emphasized through automation, aimed at reducing manual and time-consuming tasks. Innovation is embraced with the adoption of ERP technology to modernize operations and stay competitive, while data-driven decision-making ensures that real-time data is available across departments for informed strategies.

5. **Defining ERP system business requirements**

The ERP system requirements are designed to address the company's specific needs. Real-time inventory tracking is necessary to monitor inventory levels and improve production planning, ensuring no stock-outs or excess inventory. Integrated procurement and supply chain management will automate purchase orders and enhance supply chain visibility. Production scheduling and planning must be automated to optimize resource allocation and reduce delays. The system must also integrate sales and distribution channels for seamless order processing, along with financial management integration to streamline accounting, invoicing, and financial reporting.

6. **Hardware and software requirements**

As Innealtoir opts for a cloud-based ERP system, the necessity for hardware upgrades will be limited. Employees will be able to access the ERP system conveniently through their desktop and laptop computers via the website. Additionally, they will have the option to utilize mobile applications on their smartphones for on-the-go access. To facilitate optimal performance, it is crucial to have a reliable high-speed internet connection, which will ensure not only fast access to the system but also stability in its operation. Furthermore, implementing secure Wi-Fi networks is vital to safeguard sensitive information and prevent potential security breaches, ensuring that critical data remains protected. Overall, these considerations will enhance the efficiency and security of the cloud-based ERP system for all employees.

7. **Customizations needed**

Customization of the ERP system will be required to tailor it to Innealtoir's operations. Custom workflows for procurement, inventory, and production planning must be developed to align with the company's specific processes. User roles and permissions will be configured to control access to sensitive data, ensuring that only authorized personnel can view or edit certain information. The system will also need integration with third-party tools such as warehouse management systems and shipping solutions. Custom reports and dashboards will provide real-time insights into key performance indicators (KPIs), including inventory levels, production efficiency, and sales performance.

8. **Components to implement and prioritization**

To ensure a smooth ERP implementation, components will be rolled out in phases. The first phase will focus on core modules related to manufacturing and finance, such as inventory management, procurement, production planning, and financial accounting. The second phase will include the integration of sales and customer relationship management (CRM) modules to improve customer-facing operations. Finally, advanced analytics and reporting will be introduced to provide real-time insights through custom dashboards and integration with business intelligence tools like Power BI.

9. **Assessing data quality for migration**

Before migrating to the ERP system, it is crucial for Innealtoir Inc. to assess the quality of its existing data. This involves identifying and eliminating duplicate records, ensuring consistency in product codes and supplier information, and addressing any missing or outdated data, such as customer contact information or production schedules. A thorough data cleansing process will be necessary to ensure that accurate and reliable data is migrated into the new system.

10. Defining clear, measurable goals

Finally, defining clear, measurable goals is essential for tracking the success of the ERP implementation. These goals include reducing manual data entry by 70% through automation, improving on-time production and order fulfillment to 95%, increasing reporting accuracy and reducing errors by 80%, and reducing inventory carrying costs by 25% through better inventory control. These goals will provide benchmarks for evaluating the ERP system's effectiveness and ensure that the company achieves tangible improvements in efficiency and performance.

11. Building the ERP project team

The ERP project team for Innealtoir, Inc. is composed of representatives from key departments including Production, Finance, Procurement, Sales, and Human Resources. The Systems Technology Manager will serve as the Project Lead, overseeing coordination and progress tracking. The IT department will handle system integration, while department heads will ensure that operational requirements are met. An external ERP consultant will assist with technical configuration and best practice implementation to ensure a smooth rollout.

12. Identifying executive sponsors

The CEO and CFO are designated as executive sponsors for the ERP project. The CEO provides strategic direction and ensures alignment with company growth objectives, while the CFO oversees the financial aspects and budget allocation. Their active involvement ensures that high-level decisions are made promptly and that all departments remain committed to the project's success.

13. Understanding how ERP changes work

With the ERP system, employees will shift from manual spreadsheets to a fully integrated platform. Key processes such as production tracking, materials planning, procurement, and reporting will now run within the ERP, centralizing information and giving teams real-time visibility into inventory, orders, and production. This means fewer manual updates, better coordination between departments, and more accurate reporting. Comprehensive training will ensure employees can use the system effectively, emphasizing how it improves efficiency, reduces repetitive tasks, and enhances performance tracking across the supply chain.

14. Creating a change management plan

A structured communication and training plan has been developed to ensure smooth adoption across the organization. Department heads, production leads, and supervisors will act as change champions, guiding their teams through each phase of implementation. Their role includes promoting ERP awareness, assisting in training, and ensuring compliance with new processes. Regular feedback and progress reviews will be held after each milestone, giving employees a platform to share experiences, raise issues, and suggest improvements. This feedback loop supports continuous refinement and maintains employee engagement and confidence throughout the transition.

15. Defining the implementation timeline

The ERP rollout will take approximately nine (9) months to complete and will be executed in structured phases to minimize disruption to production.

- Phase 1 - Inventory & Sales (4 months):
  Focuses on deploying modules for inventory control, materials management and sales order processing. This phase will improve stock accuracy, streamline procurement, and enhance coordination between warehouse and sales operations.

- Phase 2 - Finance & CRM (5 months):
  Covers the integration of financial management, accounting, costing and customer relationship management (CRM). This phase will provide better financial visibility, automate key accounting processes, and strengthen customer engagement through data-driven insights.

An additional month is allocated for comprehensive system testing and end-user training before going live. This ensures that all modules perform as expected and that employees are confident in using the system.

16. Identifying factors that could delay or derail implementation

Several factors could cause delays or problems during the ERP implementation. These include data migration issues, where incorrect or incomplete data may slow down the setup process. Employee resistance to change can also affect progress if users are not ready to adapt to the new system. Technical problems, such as software errors or slow internet connections, could interrupt testing and training. Lastly, budget and scheduling issues may happen if tasks take longer than expected or need extra resources. Proper planning, clear communication, and strong management support will help reduce these risks.

17. Establishing a budget

We will set a phased implementation budget aligned to our rollout (Phase 1: Inventory/Procurement/Production; Phase 2: Finance/CRM; plus testing & training), with line items for: (1) Software subscriptions (named users + required modules), (2)

Implementation partner services (process design, configuration, testing), (3) Data migration & integrations (WMS/shipping, basic BI), (4) Training & change management, (5) Internal backfill/OT to cover key users, and (6) 10–15% contingency. For a medium-sized manufacturer (~100 users), an initial Year-1 budget target of ₱14M–₱18M is reasonable, broken down approximately as: subscriptions ₱4.5M–₱6.0M, partner services ₱4.5M–₱6.0M, migration & integrations ₱0.8M–₱1.4M, training & change ₱0.6M–₱1.0M, internal backfill ₱0.7M–₱1.2M, contingency ₱1.2M–₱1.8M—kept lean by our cloud deployment (minimal hardware spend) and the two-phase rollout that prioritizes shop-floor and inventory control first, then customer-facing and finance processes. This budget directly supports our documented goals to automate manual work, improve on-time fulfillment, and reduce inventory carrying costs.

18. Determining the total cost of ownership (TCO) and ROI

We will assess a 5-year TCO that includes subscriptions, partner support (AMS), minor enhancements, and one-time implementation costs (services, migration/integrations, training/change, internal backfill, contingency), with negligible hardware due to a cloud-first approach. For ~100 users, one-time Year-1 costs are estimated at **₱8.0–₱10.0M**, while recurring subscriptions and AMS are **₱6.0–₱7.5M per year** plus **₱0.5–0.7M** annually for enhancements from Year 2, yielding a **5-year TCO of roughly ₱36–₱42M**. Benefits will be quantified against our goals—automation, on-time fulfillment, and lower inventory carrying costs—by modeling savings from reduced average inventory and carrying costs, productivity gains from less manual entry, fewer stockouts/expedites and scrap/rework via better planning, and finance improvements (e.g., lower DSO and error rates), totaling **~₱9–₱11M per year** on conservative assumptions. With an initial cash outlay of **₱15–₱17M**, the expected **payback period is ~18–22 months**, and over five years we project a **positive ROI** of **~₱45–₱55M** in benefits versus **₱36–₱42M** in TCO. We will validate and refine these numbers during Phase-1 design by establishing baseline KPIs (inventory turns, schedule adherence, expedite costs, error rates) and tracking realized savings throughout the rollout; figures are planning ranges subject to adjustment after detailed scoping and vendor quotes.

19. Creating a training plan

A comprehensive training program will be implemented for all ERP users across departments. The plan includes a combination of hands-on workshops, online tutorials, and guided sessions led by the IT and ERP consulting teams. Training will take place during the testing and pilot phases to prepare employees before the official rollout. Selected key users from each department will receive advanced training to serve as in-house ERP champions, providing ongoing support and mentoring to their peers.

20. Identifying systems that will become irrelevant

The new ERP system will take over the functionalities currently handled by Excel spreadsheets for inventory tracking purposes, QuickBooks for accounting and financial management, and the existing standalone order processing system. By integrating these various operations into a single platform, we aim to streamline our processes and enhance efficiency. This transition will centralize all business data, enabling easier access and management, and ultimately improving our overall operational effectiveness.

Step 4 - ERP Evaluation Table Link: ITISSES-S15-G06 ERP Evaluation

Step 5 - Final Recommendation:

Netsuite

1. Netsuite has a dedicated manufacturing edition that includes different modules that support the whole manufacturing process. It includes:
    - MRP (Material Requirements Planning)
    - Work Order & Assemblies Management
    - Shop Floor Control
    - WIP & Routing
    - Production Scheduling and Resource Planning
2. Netsuite provides real-time monitoring of production, financial, and supply chain data
3. Inventory management has its own modules, **SuiteInventory** and **Advanced Supply Chain**, that enable procurement automation, batch tracking, and demand forecasting
4. Netsuite also enables analytics through SuiteAnalytics for customizable dashboards and KPIs tracking

Recommended modules:

- **1. Financial Management Module:**
  To establish a solid foundation for the ERP system. It ensures accurate accounting, cost tracking, and budget control — critical for managing production expenses from the start.

- **2. Inventory and Supply Chain Management Module:**
  This should come next, as real-time inventory visibility is key in manufacturing. It helps prevent stockouts, manage raw materials efficiently, and improve supplier coordination.

- **3. Manufacturing Module (MRP, Work Orders, Shop Floor Control):**
  Once finance and inventory are stable, implementing the manufacturing module optimizes production scheduling, resource allocation, and quality control on the shop floor.

- **4. Customer Relationship Management Module:**
  After core processes are automated, integrating CRM allows better forecasting, order management, and customer service alignment with production capacity.